any grounds were given, they could run the danger of these becoming cause to approach the courts and for litigation.

The agenda for the constitution of the selection committee for a new chairman, with Ratan, Srinivasan, Chandra, Sen, and Lord Kumar Bhattacharyya as an independent outsider, was carried over Mistry's objections and Khambata's and Hussain's abstention. The proposal to appoint Ratan as interim chairman was also passed. Before the meeting concluded, Ratan told Mistry that a press release would be issued after showing it to him.

After the meeting, Ratan and Singh went downstairs to a room on the second floor. They called Mukund Rajan, the chief brand custodian of the group, and requested him to draft a press release, show it to Mistry and release it to the press. Then came a request from Mistry to delay the release until the night. Singh recalls that this was not something that they were willing to accede to. There are many civil courts in Mumbai and a stay from any one of them would have frustrated all their efforts. So, what was prepared was to be released to the press.

It was a dilemma for Ratan. He confesses, 'Even for me, firing him this way was not our style of doing things. Our lawyers said that if it is not a surgical strike, he will go to the court and litigation would follow.' He said Mistry should have been more dignified and graciously resigned after it became clear that he had lost the confidence of the majority of the directors. Buttressing his argument, he added that it is not uncommon for CEOs to be ousted by boards and they go with dignity and respect.

After the resolution to replace Mistry was adopted, Ratan requested that a motion be moved recognizing Mistry's services over the last four years. He further added that Mistry could decide if he wanted to remain on the board of Tata Sons, to which he expressed his keenness. Hussain further inquired if Mistry would remain as director in other companies. This question, however, went unanswered.

After the board meeting that lasted for an hour, Mistry returned to his office, for the last time, to gather his personal belongings. He inquired if he should come the next day but was told by Subedar that it would not be required. Thereupon, Mistry called his childhood friend and a well-known lawyer Apurva Diwanji, who arrived within ten minutes. Mistry was spirited off to the Forbes headquarters, owned by Pallonji, in the neighbourhood, through a side entrance of Bombay House.